ninth / wise + dom – wisdom / argue + ment– argument

d) In the following words, the final 'e' is retained to keep 'c' or 'g' soft before 'a' or 'o'.

e.g. change + able – changeable / manage + able – manageable / courage + ous – courageous / trace + able – traceable / notice + able - noticeable

2. Final 'y'

a) In words ending in a consonant + 'y', the letter 'y' changes to 'ie' before '-s' and to 'i' before –ed, -er, -est and –ly.

e.g. lady + s – ladies / carry + s – carries / fairy + s – fairies/ worry + ed – worried/ fry + ed – fried / marry + ed – married / lucky + er – luckier / funny + er – funnier / happy + er – happier / easy + est – easiest / funny + est – funniest / busy + est - busiest / easy + ly – easily / happy + ly – happily

b) The letter 'y' does not change if it comes after a vowel letter.

e.g. pray + s – prays / pray + ed – prayed / pray + ing – praying / pray + er – prayer

c) Exceptions to the rule

e.g. pay + ed – paid / say + ed – said / day + ly – daily

d) The letter 'y' in the end does not change before '-ing'.

e.g. try + ing – trying / worry + ing – worrying

e) The final 'ie' changes to 'y' before –ing.

e.g. die + ing – dying / lie + ing – lying

3. The Final Consonant

a) In short words ending in one vowel letter + one consonant letter, the consonant is doubled before an ending with a vowel. (-ed, -ing, -er, -est)

e.g. drop + ed – dropped / bag + ed – bagged / stop + ing – stopping / plan + ing – planning / big – er – bigger / hot + est – hottest

However,

clean + ed – cleaned / weak + er – weaker (two vowels)/ ask + ed – asked / fast + er – faster (two consonants)

b) In longer words, the final syllable is doubled if the last part of the word is stressed.

e.g. begin + ing – beginning / refer + ed – referred / admit + ed – admitted

c) The consonant is not doubled if the last part of the word is unstressed.

e.g. visit + ing – visiting / suffer + ing – suffering / open + ed – opened

But if the words ends with 'l', the letter 'l' is doubled in British English, even if the last part of the word is unstressed.

e.g. travel + ed – travelled / travel + er – traveller / quarrel + ing– quarrelling

(Note the exception: parallel + ed – paralleled)

d) If the word to which the suffix –ful is added ends in 'll', one 'l' is dropped in British English.

e.g. skill + ful– skilful

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